

Is anyone here concerned about the environmental effects of Ai?

Posted by u/alanskimp • 0 points • 18 comments

Or are we all gung ho for Ai no matter the cost?

Comments

u/Forward_Yam_4013 • 2 points • 2025-12-02 20:07 UTC

Not anybody capable of doing basic math, no.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-12-02 10:28 UTC

[removed]

u/RedditCommenter38 • 2 points • 2025-12-02 10:12 UTC

The pay off is much greater than many other products

If we want to cut down on pollution we should ban useless crap not attack soemthing smart and useful.

Let's ban licorice flavored spiked anal plugs and portable air conditioners first eh?

u/smoke-bubble • 3 points • 2025-12-02 09:38 UTC

Why should we? Internet spam emails require the energy of at least 14 power plants. AI is not even close to the half of it.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-12-02 09:16 UTC

[removed]

u/WatercressExciting20 • 2 points • 2025-12-02 09:12 UTC

Not a damn bit.

u/BB_InnovateDesign • 2 points • 2025-12-02 09:07 UTC

AI needs to be sustainable at all levels, including providing a net environmental benefit. I sincerely hope that it can lead the way in solving all manner of environmental problems we face, including its own operation. I think most people are concerned about the environment, but personally, I am hopeful that AI models will pioneer solutions for clean, efficient energy that have eluded us until now (or that nations have been reluctant to implement).

u/alanskimp • 1 points • 2025-12-02 09:08 UTC

I think intelligence (of us humans) is not the issue but reluctance is the problem.

u/BB_InnovateDesign • 2 points • 2025-12-02 12:59 UTC

In that case, hopefully AI will be able to persuade the powers that be that having a habitable planet is a worthwhile goal.

u/Calm_Opportunist • 2 points • 2025-12-02 09:02 UTC

https://www.reddit.com/r/singularity/comments/1o8pr6s/journalist_debunks_environmental_attacks_on_ai/?utm_source=share&utm_medium=mweb3x&utm_name=mweb3xcss&utm_term=1&utm_content=share_button

u/tinny66666 • 12 points • 2025-12-02 08:55 UTC

Data centers account for 2% of total electricity use, and AI accounts for about 20% of the electricity at data centers (streaming and social media use more). It's expected data centers will use about 4% of electricity by 2030. About 10% of new power generation is going to data centers.

Are you sure you are aware of the harm in context of other uses and not singling out AI? Are you equally upset about streaming and social media, since they use more electricity (and correspondingly, more water, etc)?

u/PotentialAd8443 • 3 points • 2025-12-02 09:05 UTC

Sadly there has been a ton of false claims being passed around the internet and news outlets, and people don't like to do their own research.

u/unilateral_sin • -1 points • 2025-12-02 09:02 UTC

You missed how "much" water AI uses up.

u/Sixhaunt • 2 points • 2025-12-02 09:14 UTC

According to Sam Altman a GPT query takes approximately 0.3 milliliters of water. For comparison if you have a pound of ground beef then that's 1,800-2,400 gallons of water to produce it. I doubt anyone has ever used GPT enough to have used more water than a single steak. Like I would have to do about 22,712,460 queries to equate to a pound of beef if I use the lower of those two figures. If someone sent 1 request per minute without sleeping then it would take them over 43 years to use as much water as a single pound of ground beef.

u/unilateral_sin • 2 points • 2025-12-02 10:04 UTC

Yeah I totally agree and I've been arguing this, I just thought I'd point out another commonly used misconception used to show AI is bad for the environment.

u/createch • 5 points • 2025-12-02 09:13 UTC

If this is accurate a hamburger takes about as much water as 200,000 ChatGPT queries.

<https://preview.redd.it/ac99eb4hcr4g1.jpeg?width=1456&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=52275e549802e7c6b41c711d3606f0ae08364427>

u/tinny66666 • 6 points • 2025-12-02 09:06 UTC

I don't have the figures handy, but water use proportional to power use, so AI still uses less water than social media and streaming, yet we don't see the same level of hate toward those despite being more harmful. It speaks of an agenda that is not based on fact.

u/alanskimp • -1 points • 2025-12-02 08:57 UTC

Yes its all a concern...

u/NoNameeDD • 1 points • 2025-12-02 08:53 UTC

Ask Bill Gates.

u/BotTubTimeMachine • 3 points • 2025-12-02 08:50 UTC

I think it could help develop tech for cleaner, cheaper energy.